

April

5

1943

Surviving the sea

Brazilian fishermen rescued Chinese sailor Poon Lim, who had been adrift at sea for 133 days on a wooden raft after his ship sank in the Atlantic Ocean. He had survived on rainwater and fish.



1965 Lava lamp

An egg timer filled with strange bubbling liquids inspired British accountant Edward Craven Walker to design one of the most eye-catching light fixtures of the 1960s.



Also on this day

1722 Dutch seafarer Jacob Roggeveen became the first European to visit Easter Island (Rapa Nui) in the Pacific Ocean and meet its Indigenous people.

1818 Chile won its struggle for independence from Spain at the Battle of Maipú.

1998 The world's longest suspension bridge, the six-lane Akashi Kaikyo, opened in Japan. It crosses the Akashi Strait and connects the cities of Kobe and Iwaya.

Born this day

1973 Pharrell Williams, Black American musician and producer. Rising to fame as part of the music group N.E.R.D., he has scored major hits such as *Get Lucky* and *Happy*.

Robotic arm

2012

US whizz kid Easton LaChappelle took his design for a 3D-printed robotic arm to the Colorado State Science Fair. A meeting there with a girl with a US \$80,000 prosthetic arm made him want to create affordable prosthetic alternatives. The next year Easton presented his ideas at a science fair at the White House.

